Daily Bible Note

Date: 2026-10-31

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: Song of Solomon 8:1-14

1 Oh, that you were like my brother, Who nursed at my mother's breasts! If I should find you outside, I would kiss you; I would not be despised.

2 I would lead you and bring you Into the house of my mother, She who used to instruct me. I would cause you to drink of spiced wine, Of the juice of my pomegranate.

3 His left hand is under my head, And his right hand embraces me.

4 I charge you, O daughters of Jerusalem, Do not stir up nor awaken love Until it pleases.

5 Who is this coming up from the wilderness, Leaning upon her beloved? I awakened you under the apple tree. There your mother brought you forth; There she who bore you brought you forth.

6 Set me as a seal upon your heart, As a seal upon your arm; For love is as strong as death, Jealousy as cruel as the grave; Its flames are flames of fire, A most vehement flame.

7 Many waters cannot quench love, Nor can the floods drown it. If a man would give for love All the wealth of his house, It would be utterly despised.

8 We have a little sister, And she has no breasts. What shall we do for our sister In the day when she is spoken for?

9 If she is a wall, We will build upon her A battlement of silver; And if she is a door, We will enclose her With boards of cedar.

10 I am a wall, And my breasts like towers; Then I became in his eyes As one who found peace.

11 Solomon had a vineyard at Baal Hamon; He leased the vineyard to keepers; Everyone was to bring for its fruit A thousand silver coins.

12 My own vineyard is before me. You, O Solomon, may have a thousand, And those who tend its fruit two hundred.

13 You who dwell in the gardens, The companions listen for your voice— Let me hear it!

14 Make haste, my beloved, And be like a gazelle Or a young stag On the mountains of spices.

II. Key Summary

• She wishes her beloved were like a brother who nursed at her mother's breasts, so that she could kiss him outside and not be despised; she would bring him into her mother's house. Then she charges the daughters of Jerusalem again: "Do not stir up nor awaken love Until it pleases" (vv. 1-4).

• Someone asks, "Who is this coming up from the wilderness, Leaning upon her beloved?" She asks him to set her as a seal upon his heart and arm, saying love is as strong as death and many waters cannot quench it; if a man gave all the wealth of his house for love, it would be utterly despised (vv. 5-7).

• The brothers talk about what to do for their little sister, "If she is a wall… if she is a door"; she says, "I am a wall," and she became in his eyes as one who found peace. Solomon's vineyard brings a thousand silver coins, and she says, "My own vineyard is before me." Finally the beloved says, "Let me hear it!" and she answers, "Make haste, my beloved" (vv. 8-14).

III. Passage Analysis

Bringing Her Beloved Back to Where It Began

> She happily takes the image of the wall for herself… she is announcing her maturity, and her readiness for the love and marriage she has been celebrating. [1]

At the start of the book, she was the girl her brothers sent to keep the vineyards (1:6). In this chapter she comes back home, and when her brothers say, "If she is a wall… if she is a door," she takes up the word "wall" and says, "I am a wall, And my breasts like towers" (vv. 9-10).

The words her brothers used out of worry, she now uses to announce that she has grown up.

Mature, and Still Saying "Make Haste"

> In every way we have seen a marriage in maturity. ⋯ in the greater security of the wife, in her playful freedom to initiate love, and finally in the fullness of their relationship the poet has sketched a revealing portrait of the model couple. [2]

You can see these things in this chapter. She takes the lead: "I would lead you and bring you Into the house of my mother" (v. 2), unlike 1:4, when "The king has brought me into his chambers." She says, "I am a wall," and she became in his eyes "As one who found peace" (v. 10). In 2:17 she said, "Until the day breaks And the shadows flee away, Turn, my beloved," but the last line of the book is "Make haste, my beloved" (v. 14): the relationship has matured, yet it has not lost its passion and excitement [3].

Mature love is more secure and freer to reach out; from "until the day breaks" to "make haste," her longing to see him has not faded at all.

IV. Reflection Question

In its last chapter, the Song says, "Many waters cannot quench love, Nor can the floods drown it." Do you long to have, and to keep for good, a love this passionate and sweet?

From "Do not stir up nor awaken love Until it pleases" (2:7), to seeking him at night but not finding him (3:1-2), to opening the door only to find that her beloved "had turned away and was gone" (5:6), this love has known both waiting and missing each other. In the last chapter she comes home leaning closely on her beloved (8:5) and asks him to set her as a seal upon his heart, like pressing a seal, so that they would belong to each other for as long as they live (8:6) [4]; she tells the brothers who once worried about her, "I am a wall," announcing that she has grown up (8:10); and she says, "My own vineyard is before me": she herself is hers alone to decide about (8:12) [1]. All along the way, it comes down to what she says: "Many waters cannot quench love, Nor can the floods drown it" (8:7).

References

[1] Chinese Christian Bible Study Resources (ccbiblestudy.org), Song of Songs 8 Notes (Tyndale Old Testament Commentaries), https://www.ccbiblestudy.org/Old%20Testament/22Song/22GT08.htm

[2] Enduring Word, David Guzik (quoting Glickman, Song 8:14), https://enduringword.com/bible-commentary/song-of-solomon-8/

[3] Enduring Word, David Guzik (Song 8:14), https://enduringword.com/bible-commentary/song-of-solomon-8/

[4] Enduring Word, David Guzik (quoting Kinlaw, Song 8:6), https://enduringword.com/bible-commentary/song-of-solomon-8/